

Gould found the pawn he needed in Abel Corbin, who was involved in politics and was married to Grant's sister, Jennie. Gould befriended Corbin, and with the extra persuasion of a bribe, captured the ally he needed to sway the government's open market operations. Corbin first used his political influence to appoint General Daniel Butterfield to the post of U.S. sub-Treasurer in New York. Butterfield was instructed to alert Corbin to any government gold sales in advance, which would protect Gould from being surprised by any government actions.³⁰ Both Corbin and Butterfield were promised \$1.5 million stakes in the scheme, aligning their interests with Gould's.³¹

More important than Butterfield, through the summer of 1869 Corbin worked his way into the president's confidence with the singular goal of convincing him to cease selling gold. Corbin also succeeded in getting Gould and Grant to converse at social gatherings, allowing Gould to provide his convoluted rationale that a rising gold price would be for the nation's benefit.³² Corbin eventually succeeded, getting word from Grant on September 2 that he planned to stop gold sales for the month.³³

Gould had been stockpiling gold throughout August in anticipation of this favorable verdict, and upon receiving the news, he kicked it into overdrive. He enlisted a wealthy ally, Jay Fisk, with whom he had pulled off other illegal market feats. With the added funds of Fisk, Gould pumped even more money into the gold market, driving up the price.³⁴